

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is a letter to the editor about parenting:

Helicopter parenting – good or bad?

The phrase ‘helicopter parenting’ is used to describe parents who hover over their kids at all times, ready to step in at a moment’s notice to keep their children safe. I believe helicopter parenting can be a good thing for younger children. However, others think that helicopter parents create conditions that make it difficult for their kids to succeed.

Our job as parents is to protect our kids and give them the tools they need to both survive and succeed in the real world. We all want our kids to grow up to be productive members of society. No one wants to be the parent who suffocates their kid. Our role is to protect them 24 hours a day, seven days a week when they first come into the world and then gradually ease off, giving them more and more freedom and responsibility as they prove ready for the task. And while kids fight for more freedom, it is ultimately up to the parent to decide what they are ready to handle on their own.

We all look down on parents who are not involved enough with their kids, who don’t spend enough time teaching them. The danger with helicopter parents is when they don’t allow their own kids to make decisions to keep themselves safe. Those are the kids who grow up to be kids unable to make good choices and unable to protect themselves from their own stupidity.

Your group wants to write a letter to the editor to express your views about helicopter parenting. Discuss what to include in the letter. You may want to talk about:

- the qualities of good parents
- whether helicopter parenting is good
- other complaints young people have about the relationship with their parents
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you make your own decisions in your family?
2. When you have a problem, do you ask your parents or your friends for help?
3. Is it helpful for parents to always check on their children’s studies?
4. Why do you think some parents want to control everything in their child’s life?
5. Do you think helicopter parenting is common nowadays?
6. Should parents allow their children to make mistakes?
7. What is the best way for parents to monitor their child’s development?
8. How can parents and children have better communication?